

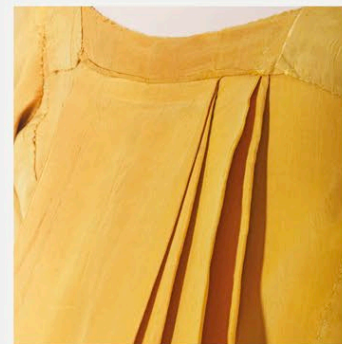


IN DETAIL



◁ STOMACHER

Although this stomacher is in poor condition, originally it would have been heavily embellished with coloured silk and metallic threads in a floral embroidery design. The stomacher was pinned or stitched on to the stays and could potentially be worn with a range of different dresses.



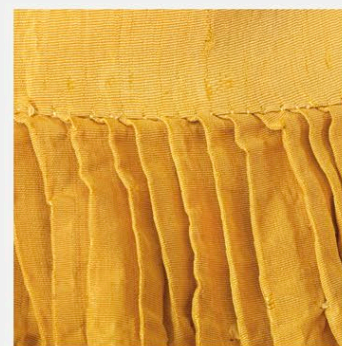
◁ BOX PLEATS

Deep pleats of silk stitched into the back of the neckline allowed the fabric to fan out over the back of the dress to display the quality and quantity of the silk.



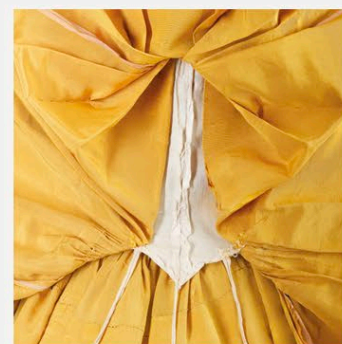
◁ LACE SLEEVE RUFFLES

Sleeves were cut tight to the elbow, and finished with cuffs, which were gathered and hand-stitched onto the sleeves in two layers of ruffles. To achieve a light appearance, the ruffles were edged with lace.



◁ CARTRIDGE PLEATING

This type of pleating, in which the fabric is folded in tight pleats, gives a great deal of volume. Cartridge pleats shaped the petticoat to expand from the narrow waistband to the width of the side hoops.



◁ POLONAISE MECHANISM

Tapes sewn into the inside of the waistband could be looped and fastened to create the draped effect known as a polonaise, which added fashionable volume to the skirts. When the dress was worn hanging down, the tapes would dangle freely beneath the skirt.